LymeFiber

Note to Phone Customers
Power Outages and LymeFiber Phone Service

Adverse weather conditions lead to power outages from time to time, and when they are sustained for significant amounts of time, they can lead to loss of telephone service. LymeFiber understands that this can be very disturbing - the loss of critical connectivity during adverse weather conditions. Note that even conventional phone service is imperfect: Customers in rural areas can and do lose phone service for a number of reasons, including the effect of weather on old and/or corroded copper facilities, power outages to service cabinets, faults in the network equipment etc.

The principal reason why LymeFiber customers may lose telephone service is loss of the internet service to their homes. This can occur for several reasons, one of which is loss of power to the home. To deal with this, LymeFiber provides subscribers with back-up batteries that automatically switch on in the event of a power outage. These batteries will last from 6-11 hours depending on how much calling is done or the internet is used, and the condition of the battery and the nature of the equipment. After the battery runs out, phone service will be lost until power comes back on or some other source of electricity is found.

The most common back-up for loss of landline service is temporary reliance on cell phones. However, many locations in LymeFiber territory do not have good cell phone reception. Assuming that cellphone service is not sufficiently reliable to provide back-up to LymeFiber wired service, there are a number of options available to our subscribers.

a) LymeFiber can install a slightly larger battery at an estimated cost of $100 which will provide up to double the life of the principal back-up battery or an even larger battery with up to three times the life of the principal battery at an estimated cost of $150.

b) Subscribers can plug the battery into a back-up generator. The cost of this varies enormously:

i) if you already have a generator, the extra cost is virtually zero;

ii) if you buy one for this purpose only, the smallest and cheapest generator will do fine. The advantage is that such generators can be used for many other things.

c) You can buy a standard "emergency battery" pack of the kind used for emergency jump-starting a car. These normally have a standard 110V outlet into which the LymeFiber network battery can be plugged. Depending on the size of the battery pack and its condition this could extend the life of the network battery by up to 8-24 hours.